

The Spelling Forge

Spelling · ages 7–adult, mixed-age friendly · 30 minutes · one screen, the free game, this page

For your homeschool table — a 30-minute lesson, zero prep. Open the free game on any screen and follow the five steps. Where a step says “the room/the group,” read it as your family; where it says “host,” that’s you.

1 · THE HOOK (3 min)

Write “necessary” on paper three ways (necessary / neccessary / necessary) and ask for a show of hands.
Reveal the memory hook: one Collar, two Sleeves — one c, two s’s.

2 · PLAY TOGETHER (12 min)

Forge ten words on the shared screen — the room SAYS each spelling aloud in chorus before the typist types.
Read every pattern box aloud; patterns, not memorization, are the lesson.

Play together: the group votes before anyone clicks, and every explanation is read aloud — the explanation is the lesson.

3 · THE TALK (8 min)

1. Which rule surprised you — doubling, drop-e, or the silent letters?
2. Why does English keep ghost letters like the k in “knee”? (history as a friend, not an enemy)
3. Homophones: when has autocorrect “fixed” you into the WRONG word?

4 · SOLO CLIMB (5 min)

Five words each at their own tier — Bronze for the young, Gold demons for the proud.

5 · THE TAKEAWAY (2 min)

“Spelling is patterns, not talent.”

Homework: Catch one spelling demon in the wild this week (a sign, a post, a menu) and bring it to the group.

THE TEACHING CREED

You are not the expert; the game is. Your job is to vote last, read aloud well, and ask “why?” one more time than feels natural. Celebrate wrong answers loudly — in here, wrong is where the lesson lives.

GENO — the GSU tutor you can talk to, free, 24/7 in 32 languages — can explain any answer a second way.